estimated that more than a hundred of them were killed or wounded; after this incident, the Chinese only approached Indian posts when they were convinced that there were no survivors.

At Chandni, the post commander, Lieutenant Rigzen, had been wounded and at first light, his men had evacuated him to DBO. The medical officer of 14 J&K Militia had been killed, but almost all posts, other than Pramodak II and Chandni II, that had been attacked were holding out. At 12.10 p.m. on 20 October, with the fighting still going on, a C-114 Packet landed at DBO. On board were Brigadier Das and another staff officer from XV Corps, Major Chaudhry. The aircraft was on the ground for forty minutes, long enough for the Intelligence havildar of 14 J&K Militia, Kishan Singh, to give the Brig Adam a detailed rundown. During this period the Chinese fired thirteen mortar shells at the aircraft, which then took off with the wounded, including Rigzen on board. Before leaving, Das gave clear orders that all posts in the outlying areas in the Qara Qash Sector were to be vacated and the troops should fall back on DBO.

On arrival at Srinagar, the wounded were shifted to hospital and Das briefed the corps commander, Bikram Singh, on the DBO situation. Immediate orders to set up a Tac HQ in Partapur were issued.

Meanwhile, back in DBO, at 4 p.m. an Indian observation post reported the arrival of a Chinese convoy consisting of eighty trucks—mainly 5- and 3-ton vehicles—ferrying nearly 1,500 troops, heavy and medium mortars along with machine gun crews.

The newly inducted troops were thrown into action almost immediately, forming up in lines and assaulting Jodha II, Pakwan and Bishan II. As a result of this massive attack, all three posts were overrun by 7 p.m., all defenders having been killed except for two men who managed to escape and fall back on Pramodak I (Tr Jn), the largest base in the DBO area that was now converted into a defended locality.

Meanwhile at Takkar, Subedar Diwan Chand, the post commander, ordered the men at two smaller posts to fall back on his position that was under sporadic, though somewhat inaccurate fire. At 8 p.m., the Chinese launched a simultaneous assault on Bishan, Chandni, Trikoni and Pakwan posts. The fighting was intense and bitter, the Chinese advancing despite casualties, hoping that the Indians would eventually run out of ammunition. Bishan fell after an hour’s fighting, but the JCO commanding the position smartly took up an alternative position that deterred the Chinese from